

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

HOUSE JOINT MEMORIAL NO. 21

BY WAYS AND MEANS COMMITTEE

A JOINT MEMORIAL

TO THE PRESIDENT OF THE UNITED STATES, THE SENATE AND THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE UNITED STATES IN CONGRESS ASSEMBLED, THE CONGRESSIONAL DELEGATION REPRESENTING THE STATE OF IDAHO IN THE CONGRESS OF THE UNITED STATES, AND THE SECRETARY OF THE UNITED STATES DEPARTMENT OF WAR.

We, your Memorialists, the House of Representatives and the Senate of the State of Idaho assembled in the Second Regular Session of the Sixty-eighth Idaho Legislature, do hereby respectfully represent that:

WHEREAS, Idaho, the 43rd state in the Union, was named the Gem State because of its abundance of gemstones and minerals; and

WHEREAS, responsible resource development is of the utmost importance for our state and country; and

WHEREAS, tungsten is a vital material for defense applications; with unparalleled hardness and high-temperature resistance, it is indispensable for armor-piercing ammunition, missile components, and aerospace manufacturing; and

WHEREAS, the U.S. Department of War and the Defense Industrial Base Consortium classify tungsten as a critical mineral; and

WHEREAS, currently, the United States remains heavily reliant on importing critical minerals, primarily from China, which dominates over 80% of the global supply; and

WHEREAS, China's recent ban on tungsten exports underscores the need to establish a stable, U.S.-domiciled supply chain of tungsten to safeguard national security interests; and

WHEREAS, the U.S. Department of War and the Defense Industrial Base Consortium have issued a solicitation to provide grant moneys for the development of a domestic supply of critical minerals, including tungsten; and

WHEREAS, mining activity for critical minerals, including tungsten, has historically taken place at American Tungsten's IMA mine in Lemhi County, near Patterson, Idaho; and

WHEREAS, a mining company, American Tungsten is seeking to bring IMA mining operations back to life so as to unearth critical resources, including tungsten, and increase our nation's crucially needed domestic supply of critical mineral resources; and

WHEREAS, the IMA mine project is a high-quality underground tungsten deposit located on private land with patented rights that is well above the water table and has significant existing infrastructure given its historic use; and

WHEREAS, as the IMA mine is on private property rather than federal property, the mine will not require permits or other authorizations from the federal government but rather permits and authorizations from state agencies and local governments; and

1 WHEREAS, once permitted, the IMA mine will be the only tungsten-produc-
2 ing mine in the United States; and

3 WHEREAS, modern rules and regulations require that companies like Amer-
4 ican Tungsten set aside adequate financial assurances to cover the cost
5 of environmental restoration, ensuring that reclamation is properly com-
6 pleted; and

7 WHEREAS, American Tungsten is committed to the highest reclamation
8 standards and to strictly following all applicable federal and state laws,
9 regulations, and rules; and

10 WHEREAS, American Tungsten is committed to being a good steward of the
11 environment and a dedicated member of the community where it operates; and

12 WHEREAS, as an example of American Tungsten's commitment to its commu-
13 nity, it will provide, through financing, the city of Challis a new fire sta-
14 tion to serve the community; and

15 WHEREAS, the American Tungsten company takes pride in providing
16 high-paying job opportunities for Idaho workers, building collaborative
17 relationships, and investing in the long-term resiliency of Idaho's rural
18 communities; and

19 WHEREAS, once permitted, the IMA mine project will significantly bene-
20 fit Idaho's economy, particularly in Lemhi and Custer counties, by using lo-
21 cal vendors, thereby increasing revenue for local businesses; and

22 WHEREAS, through high-paying jobs, tax revenues, donations, community
23 sponsorships, and other direct and indirect economic impacts, American
24 Tungsten's resources are essential to the nation's national security, to the
25 region's economic stability, and for keeping Idahoans working in Idaho.

26 NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the members of the Second Regular Ses-
27 sion of the Sixty-eighth Idaho Legislature, the House of Representatives and
28 the Senate concurring therein, that the Legislature recognizes the profound
29 role mining has played in the settlement of Idaho, its contemporary role, and
30 the role it will play in our future.

31 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Idaho Legislature supports and encour-
32 ages state agencies and local governments to move forward and approve Amer-
33 ican Tungsten's IMA mine in a timely and cost-effective manner so that the
34 mine may be developed.

35 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Legislature urges the U.S. Department
36 of War and the Defense Industrial Base Consortium to award grant moneys to
37 American Tungsten for the development of the IMA mine project.

38 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Chief Clerk of the House of Represen-
39 tatives be, and she is hereby authorized and directed to forward a copy of
40 this Memorial to the President of the United States, the President of the
41 Senate and the Speaker of the House of Representatives of Congress, the con-
42 gressional delegation representing the State of Idaho in the Congress of the
43 United States, and the Secretary of the United States Department of War.